

Jim Gillespie

Austin, TX | (512) 230-4673 | j3gillespie@gmail.com | [linkedin.com/in/jgilles](https://www.linkedin.com/in/jgilles) | j-gillespie.github.io/portfolio

SUMMARY

Senior Technical Writer with 20+ years of experience documenting complex software, hardware, and SaaS products. Proven track record collaborating with engineering, product, and UX teams in Agile environments to deliver accurate, structured documentation that accelerates product adoption and reduces support overhead. Consistently recognized for managing multiple projects in dynamic environments and delivering high-quality content under tight deadlines.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Agile/Scrum Methodology | Cross-Functional Collaboration | Global Distributed Team Coordination | Continuous Improvement | Project Management | Mentoring | Emotional Intelligence | Troubleshooting

Technical Writing: Structured Authoring | Content Management | Information Architecture | Documentation Strategy | DITA/XML | HTML | FrameMaker | Adobe Creative Suite | Oxygen Author | XMetaL

Docs-as-Code: Git/GitHub | Azure DevOps | Markdown | Confluence | Jira | CMS | Version Control

API & Developer Docs: OpenAPI/Swagger | REST API Documentation | Integration Guides | Developer Documentation | Release Notes | SDK-Related Content

Other Technologies: Windows | MacOS | Linux (Redhat, CentOS, Ubuntu) | JavaScript | Python (beginner) | Java | C++ | Git | Visual Studio | VMware

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Independent Technical Writer | Austin, TX | Jan 2024–Present

- Provided actionable feedback in peer code reviews, improving usability of developer-facing documentation.
- Created and deployed a GitHub Pages portfolio site using Docusaurus, Markdown, HTML, React, and Git.
- Built, tested, and documented a functional mock REST API using JSON, HTTP methods, and Postman.
- Completed coursework in API documentation, generative AI, cloud computing, and data analysis to stay current during career transition; applied this learning directly to portfolio projects.

Senior Technical Writer | National Instruments | Austin, TX | Feb 2014–Dec 2023

- Collaborated with engineers, developers, and product managers to translate complex technical concepts into clear, user-friendly content to help customers succeed, prevent support tickets, and ensure a positive product experience.
- Owned the end-to-end documentation lifecycle for automotive hardware and software products, including installation guides, user manuals, online help, hardware documentation, API reference documentation, and release notes; collaborated and coordinated with development teams based locally and in Aachen, Germany to develop and update documentation for new releases.
- Updated hardware specifications and revamped the PXIe-4322 user manual by collaborating with engineers and Support to add content and ensure accuracy, completeness, and Compliance approval; secured stakeholder approval, enabling \$1.5M in customer order fulfillment.
- Documented beta releases that drove customer sales and facilitated marketing of automotive test solutions, contributing to fewer customer support calls.
- Led monthly cross-functional meetings with Metrology, Calibration, and Technical Communication, setting agendas and priorities so teams could resolve issues and deliver information and projects on time, keeping engineers and writers aligned on customer expectations and organizational goals.
- Migrated product documentation and build components from Perforce to Git, integrating with a developer-focused toolchain (Jira, Confluence, and Microsoft Azure DevOps) to streamline build processes.

Information Developer | HP TippingPoint (Contract) | Austin, TX | Jan 2013–Feb 2014

- Documented the HP Next-Generation Firewall system; configured test environments to verify features and process flow.
- Participated in usability testing to inform documentation decisions; attended daily scrums to track feature changes, known issues, and bugs, keeping documentation current and complete; championed documentation needs in sprint planning, proactively confirming details with developers to ensure accuracy. Documentation shipped on time with product releases and was more complete, with developers flagging issues for documentation.
- Mentored new writers, training them on processes, tools, and best practices; pioneered writer participation in certifications for HPE network security solutions, sparking team-wide adoption and building deeper technical fluency across the writing team.

EARLY CAREER

Advanced Micro Devices (AMD) | Technical Writer (Contract) | 2011–2012

Reddwerks | Technical Writer | 2010–2011

TippingPoint | Technical Writer (Contract) | 2010

National Instruments | Technical Writer (Contract) | 2009–2010

IBM | Information Developer | 2000–2009

Additional experience and details available upon request.

EDUCATION

Master of Arts, English | Texas A&M University | College Station, TX

Bachelor of Science, English | Ball State University | Muncie, IN

CONTINUING EDUCATION & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

UX Writing, Agile User Stories, Product Management Fundamentals, Art of Facilitation, Git & GitHub, API Documentation, REST APIs for Writers, JSON & XML, Agentic AI Fundamentals, Career Essentials in Generative AI, Prompt Engineering, AI Ethics, Problem Solving, Data Visualization, Assertive Communication, Accessibility in Online Learning

College coursework in C++, Java, and Object-Oriented Programming (Austin Community College)

RECENT PROJECTS

Portfolio Site (2025): Built and deployed a portfolio site using Docusaurus, Markdown, HTML, React, and Git, hosted on GitHub Pages.

Instruments API (2025): Built, tested, and documented a functional mock REST API using JSON, HTTP methods, Visual Studio Code, Postman, and JSON Server. Validated and tested CRUD operations, including GET, POST, PUT, PATCH, and DELETE. Managed project files and documentation using a Git-based, Docs-as-Code workflow. The JSON datastore manages a catalog of musical instruments. The project demonstrates API design, CRUD operations, and hands-on use of Postman for endpoint testing and documentation.

AI-Assisted CRM Lead Follow-Up Workflow (2026): Developed a workflow specification to document the design, API behavior, and AI governance requirements for an AI-assisted lead follow-up system within a Customer Relationship Management (CRM) platform.